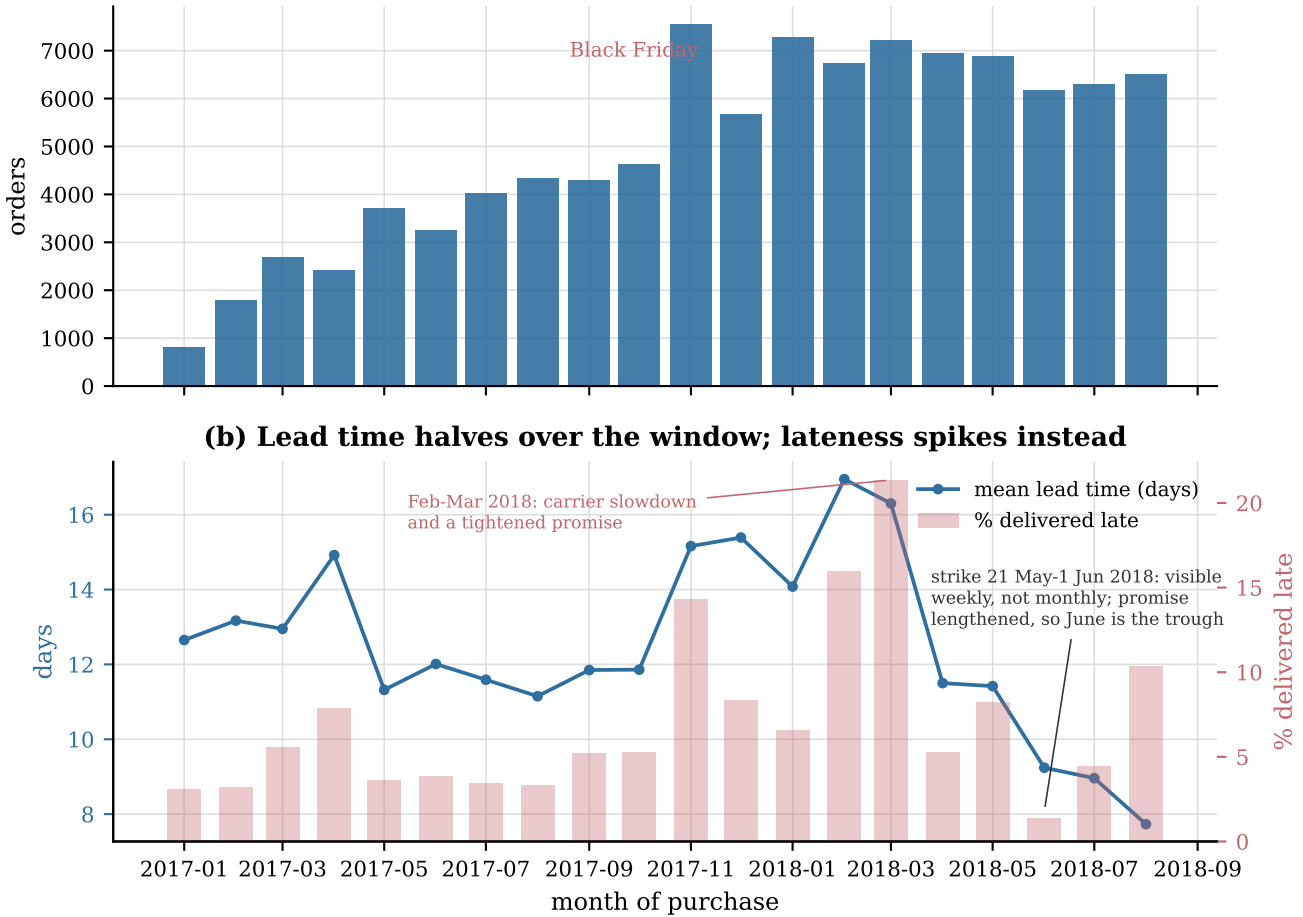
(a) Monthly order volume, with the Black Friday 2017 spike
orders
0
1000
2000
3000
4000
5000
6000
7000
Black Friday
(b) Lead time halves over the window; lateness spikes instead
days
8
10
12
14
16
% delivered late
0
5
10
15
20
Feb-Mar 2018: carrier slowdown
and a tightened promise
strike 21 May-1 Jun 2018: visible
weekly, not monthly; promise
lengthened, so June is the trough
mean lead time (days)
% delivered late
2017-01
2017-03
2017-05
2017-07
2017-09
2017-11
2018-01
2018-03
2018-05
2018-07
2018-09
month of purchase